

Легенда (жёлтым выделены фрагменты, отвечающие на критерии из презентации Research Methods 2.1)

Identifying a Research Problem: ID-1 Issue/conflict · ID-2 What prevents resolution · ID-3 Cost of not resolving · ID-4 Benefits & their significance

Characteristics of an effective research problem: CH-1 Significance · CH-2 Clarity · CH-3 Feasibility · CH-4 Novelty

CHAPTER 1

Introduction

Context of the Problem

Instructional technology use in higher education is a complex topic that has been explored by many researchers. Much of the instructional technology research has focused on the pedagogical benefits of instructional technology and the factors that influence the adoption of instructional technology by faculty.

Celik and Keskin (2009) compared student learning outcomes for a set of learning objectives taught with instructional technology to student learning outcomes for the same set of learning objectives being taught without instructional technology. They found the effective use of instructional technology decreased the amount of teaching time needed for students to learn a set of learning objectives.

To determine how faculty training impacts instructional technology integration, Georgina and Hosford (2009) surveyed faculty at 16 Midwestern colleges and universities. They found significant correlations between technology literacy and pedagogical integration of instructional technology. In other words, faculty who were comfortable with, and knew how to use, technology were more likely to use technology in their teaching than faculty who were not comfortable with technology.

Somekh (2008) reviewed research on the factors affecting instructional technology adoption and found that an important key for successful adoption of instructional technology was focusing professional development on both technical skills and pedagogical practices. The focus on technical skills and pedagogy led to instructors embedding technology in the learning processes. Somekh (2008) found that another factor to the successful adoption of instructional

стр. 2

technology in the classroom was the teachers themselves. With this focus on the educators, training and pedagogical support catered to individual differences and took into account individual teachers' personality types.

Becking (2011) used a mixed-methods approach to examine technology usage by university faculty at a large Midwestern university. She concluded that professional development and instructional technology training for instructors should be pedagogically oriented. She stated, “Instructors need to not only know where to click but also how, why, and when to use chosen technologies” (p. 198).

Research in these areas has produced information about the learning benefits of instructional technology and its adoption, however, little research has focused on the experiences of instructors who adopt instructional technology in their teaching processes. ID-1

Statement of the Problem

Researchers do not understand the implications of technology adoption on the way university faculty members teach their courses and on their everyday lives. ID-1 CH-2

Purpose of the Study

The purpose of this study was (a) to gain an in-depth understanding of the lived experiences of university faculty who adopted instructional technology for teaching and learning purposes, and (b) to determine if adoption affected the way a person taught, worked, and lived. CH-2

I examined the lived experiences of faculty who used instructional technology and taught at a large Midwestern university. CH-3 Specifically, I examined:

- If technology adoption affected the way a person taught and worked? If so, how?
- If technology adoption in the classroom affected the way a person lived outside of the classroom? If so, how?

стр. 3

- Why faculty adopted instructional technology into their teaching?
- What instructional technologies faculty adopted into their teaching.
- Where faculty looked for guidance when adopting instructional technology into their teaching?

Answering these specific questions, and, more generally, examining the lived experiences of faculty informs the development of new teaching practices and learning experiences. ID-4

In order to develop new theories, training and development processes, and best practices that may help facilitate future adoption of new technologies, it is important to understand how people use and adopt new technologies. ID-3 ID-4 It is also important to understand the faculty members’ expectations when adopting

or purchasing new technology. This information will help other faculty members manage their expectations and analyze their goals and outcomes. ID-4

Past research has focused on the pedagogical benefits of instructional technology and on variables that hinder or encourage a person to adopt technology, but researchers have not taken into account the experiences of the instructors or the social variables that may affect adoption. ID-1 CH-4

Technology adoption has been examined through the lens of several different theories, with Roger's Theory of Innovation being the most popular. ID-2 However, Kidd (2009) argued that not enough research has been done in the area of lived experiences of faculty who are using instructional technology in their teaching methods and processes.

... Roger's theory and subsequent models presented in this review do not adequately address the faculty's experience or the component of experience during the adoption process, the social or cognitive variables that shape one's ability to adopt ICTs ID-2 (Information Communication Technologies), not the individual factors that may hinder or accelerate one's decision or ability to adopt technological innovation. Therefore, a

стр. 4

paucity exists in the literature to look into the lived experiences of faculty who adopt ICTs for teaching and learning CH-1 (Kidd, 2009, p. 157).

A phenomenological approach allowed me to gain a better understanding of the process of adopting instructional technologies by university faculty and how instructional technology adoption changed the way faculty teach and live. CH-4

Definition of Terms

For the purpose of this study, "faculty" was defined as professional educators who teach courses for university credit. "Instructional technology" was defined as any technology used to aid in the teaching and learning process. CH-2

Research Questions

The central research question was: What were the experiences of faculty who adopt technology in their teaching? CH-2 Specific research questions included:

- Did technology adoption affect the way a person taught and worked? If so, how?
- Did technology adoption in the classroom affect the way a person lived outside of the classroom? If so, how?
- Why did faculty adopt instructional technology into their teaching?
- What instructional technologies were faculty adopting into their teaching.

- Where did faculty look for guidance when adopting instructional technology into their teaching?

Limitations

The limitation of this study exists in the means of sampling. The purposeful sampling method with a reputational technique does not allow researchers to generalize data to all higher education faculty members. **CH-3** Rather, results provide information for a more in-depth

стр. 5

understanding of this particular phenomenon, and the results are most pertinent only to faculty members who use instructional technology at a large Midwestern university.

Delimitations

A delimitation of the study lies in the process faculty used to select new technologies. Individuals are different in the way they discover, analyze, select, and adopt a specific technology.

Another delimitation is that individual faculty chose which development opportunities they experienced. Faculty members may have chosen not to attend a training class, for example, that may have increased their knowledge about a specific instructional technology, thus influencing their experiences during the adoption.

Significance of the Study

Professional and social implications. A clear understanding of how technology adoption may affect the way a person teaches and works offers information useful to instructional technology researchers and teaching faculty. **ID-4 CH-1**

Contributions to the literature. This phenomenological study used in-depth interviews to allow instructors to tell their stories of technology adoption. The use of interviews gave ample opportunity for the faculty voices to be heard. **CH-4** The results of the study fill the gap in the literature concerning faculty adoption of instructional technology by telling the stories of the faculty experiences. **CH-1**

Personal knowledge. As a college instructor and an information services professional, I have experienced adopting new technologies in my teaching processes, and I have helped faculty work through the same process. **CH-3** As a result of this study, I have a better understanding of the process of adopting a new instructional technology.

By analyzing the lived experiences of faculty who have adopted instructional technology into their teaching, this study produced five major outcomes: ID-4

- Provided insight into the feelings, struggles, and successes of faculty who decide to adopt instructional technologies into their teaching.
- Provided insight into the impact instructional technology adoption in the classroom has on technology use in personal life.
- Provided understanding of how instructional technology adoption affects the way a faculty member develops teaching strategies and how they teach using instructional technology.
- Identified administrative processes and philosophies that should evolve and develop. ID-4
- Identified development and support needs of faculty who adopt new technology into their teaching strategies. ID-4

Researcher Bias

In qualitative research, personal views can never be kept separate from the interpretation of the data (Creswell, 2005). As a college instructor who uses technology, an IT professional, and a former instructional design professional, my perceptions of the faculty members and their experiences have been influenced by these past experiences.

Because of my background and the fact that I performed in-depth interviews with the subjects, I was an ideal person to reflect upon and extract meaning from the data I collected. I acknowledge the following biases:

- I am an instructional technology professional who supports faculty who use instructional technologies, and develops training and development programs for faculty who want to learn about instructional technology.

- I believe that effective use of instructional technology does improve student learning.
- I am a college instructor who uses technology as a part of my teaching processes.
- I am an early adopter of new technologies. I have found that being an early adopter of technology is both rewarding and unpleasant.
- I have strong feelings about the need for college instructors to use the technology that is available to them and supported by their university.
- I believe that all college instructors have the responsibility to prepare students for challenges they will face in their careers after college; this

includes how to use technology in a professional setting.

Conclusion and Summary

Instructional technology use in higher education has become the rule rather than the exception, and faculty who do not use instructional technology in their teaching may soon feel the pressure to do so. ID-3 This phenomenological study investigated the lived experiences of 20 university faculty members who use technology in their teaching methods. CH-3 The following chapter details the literature and previous studies relevant to this study.

Глава 2 (стр. 10) — дополнительный фрагмент к ID-3

In addition, research has shown that college faculty are often slow to adopt new technologies based on fear of failure, disinterest, or aversion to change ID-3 (Friel, et al, 2009).